

## **Strong 2-♣ Opening**

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.

OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.

2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand

3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand

2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♠10

Board: 2

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: East

Lead: ♠J

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 7♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♥3

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: West

Lead: ♣A

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Lead: ♠7

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K J  
♥ J 10  
♦ A Q 9 4  
♣ J 10 9 7 2

♠ A 7 3  
♥ A K Q 8 6 2  
♦ 8 6  
♣ A K



♠ Q 10 9 8 5  
♥ 9 3  
♦ K 10 5 3  
♣ Q 4

♠ 6 4 2  
♥ 7 5 4  
♦ J 7 2  
♣ 8 6 5 3

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             | 2♣    | Pass | 2♦    |
| Pass        | 2♥    | Pass | 3♣    |
| Pass        | 3♥    |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 3♥ by North |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♠ 10  |       |      |       |

NORTH has 22 points and opens 2♣.

SOUTH is pretty weak, right? She responds 2♦.

NORTH bids his suit, 2♥.

SOUTH is so weak she bids the second negative - 3♣.

NORTH rebids his suit, 3♥, and SOUTH passes.

**Board 2**

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A K 6 3  
♥ A K 8 2  
♦ K Q J  
♣ K Q

♠ Q 9 5

♥ 6 3

♦ 10 8 7

♣ A J 10 9 2



♠ 4 2

♥ Q J 9 7 5

♦ A 5 2

♣ 7 5 3

♠ J 10 8 7

♥ 10 4

♦ 9 6 4 3

♣ 8 6 4

WEST has a nice 2♣ opening hand.

With 8 points, EAST can make a positive response so he bids his 5-card ♥ suit.

WEST likes ♥s, knows there are at least 33 points, but needs to make sure the opponents don't have two Aces so she uses Blackwood.

When EAST shows one Ace WEST bids 6♥.

| West       | North | East | South |
|------------|-------|------|-------|
| 2♣         | Pass  | 2♥   | Pass  |
| 4NT        | Pass  | 5♦   | Pass  |
| 6♥         |       |      |       |
| All Pass   |       |      |       |
| 6♥ by East |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♠J   |       |      |       |

**Board 3**

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6 5  
 ♥ 9 6 3  
 ♦ Q J 10 7 5  
 ♣ J 3 2

♠ K Q 10 2  
 ♥ A Q J 10 5  
 ♦ A K 2  
 ♣ K



♠ 7 4  
 ♥ 8 4  
 ♦ 9 8 4 3  
 ♣ Q 10 9 6 5

♠ A J 9 8 3  
 ♥ K 7 2  
 ♦ 6  
 ♣ A 8 7 4

NORTH opens 2♣ and is pleased when SOUTH makes a positive response of 2♠. His first step is to set the trump suit by bidding 3♠. There is NO chance that SOUTH will pass.

SOUTH now bids 4♣ a Control-showing bid. NORTH continues Control-showing with 4♦.

That's enough for SOUTH to hear. She invokes Blackwood and learning they have all the Aces bids 7♠.

| West | North | East | South |
|------|-------|------|-------|
|      | 2♣    | Pass | 2♠    |
| Pass | 3♠    | Pass | 4♣    |
| Pass | 4♦    | Pass | 4NT   |
| Pass | 5♠    | Pass | 7♠    |

All Pass

7♠ by South

Lead: ♥3

**Board 4**

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 10 7 2

♥ 9 8 7

♦ 8 2

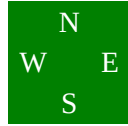
♣ Q 5 3

♠ 4 3

♥ Q 6 4

♦ J 9 4

♣ A J 9 7 4



♠ K Q 8 6

♥ A K J 2

♦ A K Q

♣ 8 6

♠ 9 5

♥ 10 5 3

♦ 10 7 6 5 3

♣ K 10 2

EAST has a minimum 2♣ opening.

WEST, with 8 points and a 5-card suit, should make a positive response, 2♠.

EAST shows the ♠ support first, to set the trump suit, and to give WEST an opportunity for a move toward slam if he wants to do so.

WEST would now make a Control-showing bid IF HE HAD A CONTROL. Since he doesn't he just returns to 4♠ which EAST passes.

*West**North**East**South*

2♠

Pass

2♣

Pass

4♠

Pass

3♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by West

Lead: ♣A

**Board 5**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 4 2  
♥ 10 9 4 3  
♦ Q J 2  
♣ K Q 10 2

♠ K 6 3  
♥ Q 8 5  
♦ K 7 6 4  
♣ 9 5 3



♠ A Q 9  
♥ A K 2  
♦ A 8 3  
♣ A J 7 4

♠ J 10 8 7 5  
♥ J 7 6  
♦ 10 9 5  
♣ 8 6

SOUTH, with 22 points and balanced, opens 2♣, expecting to rebid 2NT.

But NORTH responds a positive 2NT, showing a balanced hand with 8 or more points.

SOUTH bids what his hand is worth, 3NT and NORTH passes.

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       |      | 2♣    |
| Pass         | 2NT   | Pass | 3NT   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by North |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♠7     |       |      |       |